Shipment exceptions, handled before the customer calls

How a fictional operator could tell customers about delays before they call — framed, specified, built as a working demo, accepted and brought live in a controlled pilot.

Independent portfolio case. Tidewell Logistics is fictional; workshops, sprints and acceptance tests are simulated; figures are illustrative. Labels: proposed business case and plans · simulated fictional delivery · measured automated tests run in the repository.

THE PROBLEM

22%
of late deliveries announced before the window

38%
of all contacts are “where is my load?”

±55 / wk
missed delivery slots at ±€140

3 → 1
three requested solutions, one root cause: no rules for *late* and no owner

THE RECOMMENDATION PROPOSED

A small exception component next to the TMS: rules decide severity, owner and response time; planners work from one list; customers get one clear message. Scored 3.95 against 2.45–3.10 for the alternatives on weights agreed beforehand.

TMS change → 13 rules → owner + 30 min / 2 h → one message → resolved with reason

Buy the information first

Payback ±13.5 months *if* a third of WISMO calls disappear (pessimistic: ±31 months). So: a two-sprint pilot for five customers with a control group, ±€114k; release 2 only if WISMO falls ≥ 20%.

HOW IT WAS WORKED OUT

STEP	KEY DECISION OR ARTEFACT
Discover & event storm simulated	“Tell key accounts everything” vs. “no message storm” → severity; late = after the end of the agreed window (D-01, D-02)
Model & specify	BPMN 2.0 with timer events; 13 rules also as DMN 1.3; 30 Given/When/Then examples; traceability from pain point to KPI
Prioritise with the PO	WSJF + dependencies; release 1 = 36 points in two sprints; release 2 refined and honestly “not ready”
Build to learn measured	Working control tower on the same rules; 100+ automated tests incl. accessibility; building exposed 5 open questions and a privacy leak
Accept & go live simulated	BAT with the sceptical planner as key user; 6 findings, one from the analyst’s own refinement answer; 13 go/no-go criteria; shadow mode; rollback in 4 min

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE PROPOSED

K1 told in time
22% → ≥ 90%

K2 time to inform
3 h 10 → ≤ 30 min

K3 WISMO vs. control
–35% (gate –20%)

K7 false alarms
< 5% (guardrail)

LIMITS

No real stakeholders, data, TMS or deployment; architecture and privacy controls are proposals; no usability test with real people yet. The case shows how the analyst frames, decides, specifies and prepares delivery — it is not a substitute for team experience.

Philippe Godfroy · phlppgdfry.github.io/shipment-exception-management-business-analysis · Independent portfolio case with a fictional organisation; no confidential information from any employer · Built with AI assistance (provenance tracked privately)